PROPOSAL · APRIL 28, 2026

# Automating Looped's back office.

Fractional CTO / Automation Partner

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For Cort Koenig & Andrew Januik · Start: May 2026

TWO MEETINGS. THREE PROBLEMS.

# What we heard.

Operations, research, and the back office — all showing the same strain.

# Three gaps. All addressable.

FINANCE / OPS

## The AP inbox nobody checks

Invoices arrive, sit in a shared email, and require manual extraction, verification against C-Trade, and manual posting to QuickBooks.

> *"That's why Andrew doesn't sleep anymore."*
> *"We're living in the Stone Age."*

RESEARCH

## 20 hours per unusual lead

Every creative-solutions job requires researching end uses, locating buyers, building a call list. Leadership ends up doing it because reps aren't researchers.

> *"The pain point is the 20 hours that go into finding that phone call."*

OPERATIONS

## The back office didn't scale with you

Two new CS reps hired the day before our first meeting. The systems haven't kept up. Scheduling, confirmations, data entry — all done by humans on phones.

> *"We've grown a little faster than we expected and weren't fully ready for it."*

Constraint agreed in our meeting: all automation is invisible to clients — nothing changes on their side.

BUILD PHASE · MONTHS 1–3

# Phase 1.
# First 90 days.

Four priorities. Highest value first.
Backlog is ours to adjust week by week.

# 01 — AP / AR Invoice Automation

ANDREW'S #1 PRIORITY

Monitors the AP email inbox. Extracts invoice data from attachments (PDFs, Excel). Validates amounts against C-Trade records. Flags mismatches. Prepares QuickBooks postings for review.

Andrew stops manually touching invoices. Discrepancies surface automatically rather than silently accumulating.

**Why first:** Lowest risk — fully internal, clients never see it. Highest daily pain for Andrew. Immediate, measurable relief.

> *"That's why Andrew doesn't sleep anymore."*
>
> ANDREW JANUIK, COO

# 02 — Material Research Agent

CORT'S PRIORITY

Plugs into the Trello pipeline. When a new opportunity card is created, the agent identifies likely non-obvious end uses, surfaces nearby buyers and processors with contacts, and comments a prioritized "who to call" list — with indicative pricing — directly on the card.

Sales reps get a research head start before they ever pick up the phone.

**Their framing, built exactly:** "Finds our best options, gives us a pricing guide, and tees up exactly who we need to call."

> *"The pain point is the 20 hours that go into finding that phone call."*
>
> CORT KOENIG, CEO

# 03 — Sales Call Transcription → Trello

BOTH BENEFIT

Background audio capture — Granola-style. No bot joining the call, nothing intrusive for the prospect. After each call, generates a structured summary: material specs, open questions, pricing signals, follow-up items. Written directly to the relevant Trello card.

Cards become as detailed as the ones Cort writes himself.

**Coaching layer available:** Prompts like "Did you ask about volume timing?" can reinforce the sales process over time.

Note: you flagged that you disliked intrusive AI meeting bots from a prior tool. This approach runs in the background — the prospect never knows.

# 04 — Workflow Audit & Automation Roadmap

FOUNDATION

Document the major manual workflows end-to-end: freight quoting, account management, order tracking, document generation. Identify automation candidates by impact and risk.

Produces the prioritized roadmap that guides Retainer Phase work. We're never guessing what to build next.

**Natural next layer:** Freight quoting and account management ops are the Phase 2 targets. The audit makes sure we sequence them correctly.

- Freight quoting — always-on coverage beyond Macedonia work window
- Account management ops copilot — scheduling, confirmations, document generation
- Emergency quote blast — structured all-carrier outreach within the hour

ONGOING RELATIONSHIP, NOT PROJECT-BY-PROJECT

# The model.

Fractional CTO. What that means in practice, week to week.

# How we work together

WEEKLY

### Weekly Sync

30–45 min. Review what shipped. Hear what's burning. Adjust priorities. Keeps us aligned without overhead.

MONTHLY

### Written Summary

End of each month: what was built, current status on each project, what's next. Easy to share with stakeholders.

ONGOING

### Slack / Async Access

Day-to-day questions, edge cases, something breaks — fast loop without scheduling overhead. Reliably responsive during business hours.

RETAINER

### Bi-Weekly Sales Meeting Attendance (Month 4+)

Hearing deals in real time is how I build tools that match your actual process — not a guessed version of it.

ALWAYS

### You Own Everything Built

All automations, scripts, and documentation belong to Looped on receipt of payment. Full handoff package at any transition point. No lock-in.

PREDICTABLE MONTHLY RATE

# Investment.

No surprise bills. Third-party costs passed through at cost, with your approval.

# Pricing

## BUILD PHASE — MONTHS 1-3

**$6,500** / month

| | |
|---|---|
| Commitment | ~20 hrs / week |
| Term | 3 months |
| Total | $19,500 |

- All 4 Phase 1 deliverables
- Weekly syncs + monthly written summaries
- Async access (Slack or email)
- Full transition package at end of Month 3

## RETAINER PHASE — MONTH 4+

**$4,500** / month

| | |
|---|---|
| Commitment | ~10 hrs / week |
| Term | Month-to-month |
| Cancel notice | 30 days |

- Maintenance of all Phase 1 systems
- Continued backlog-driven build work
- Bi-weekly sales meeting attendance
- Monthly written summaries

**To start:** $3,250 deposit (50% of Month 1) due on contract signature — credited in full against Month 1 invoice. Non-refundable if Looped terminates during the Initial Term other than for my uncured material breach.

Invoices on the 1st of each month, due in 10 business days · All deliverables owned by Looped upon payment · Out-of-scope work at $150/hr with written amendment ·

# Next steps

STEP 01

### Review this proposal

Flag anything that needs adjustment — scope, timing, or pricing. Better to fix it now than mid-engagement.

STEP 02

### Sign the agreement

Electronic signatures are valid. Once signed, I'll send the $3,250 deposit invoice and we'll set a kick-off for the week of May 5.

STEP 03

### Coffee in Seattle

Cort, you're in Seattle May 2–9. Proposal first — coffee is the handshake close. May 3 or May 9.

*Ready to stop doing it manually?*

The first automation in your inbox. The research your reps need before they dial.

CONTACT

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